

Tobias Treppmann

Building AI into what we ship and how we work — championing design systems as engineering infrastructure

CONTACT

LOCATION

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PORTFOLIO

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University
2022 – Present

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching, plus design-thinking and product-strategy consulting for non-profits, religious organisations, and mission-driven ventures.

PROFILE

Senior design leader, 15+ years hands-on UX craft and 9+ years leading senior-designer teams across B2C consumer and B2B SaaS. Currently building AI at Bibel TV — a CS Copilot skill in production plus agentic prototyping the engineering team consumes directly. Earlier led Datameer's five-year cross-Atlantic design team across Germany and NYC, and shipped Spreadshirt's print-on-demand marketplace to ~5,000 business sellers.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (B2C media platform across mobile, web, and connected TV) · Hamburg, Germany · remote-first from Berlin, 2 days/week Hamburg

- Shipped an AI Copilot skill for the customer-support team that drafts replies to viewer letters and emails against the CS handbook as context
- Scoped what the skill loads, defined "good draft" with the CS team before prompt-tuning, kept the human send-decision absolute
- Made escalation a first-class output for acute-crisis messages, documented as transferable practice for AI integration into operational workflows
- AI fundraising pipeline in build alongside
- Introduced agentic prototyping as a design method — designed the new mobile app first as a web prototype, then Android
- Engineering consumes part of the prototype code directly, collapsing the design → prototype → shipped-code pipeline
- Actively evangelising AI-generated prototyping across the broader design and engineering team
- AI-assisted user research synthesis and transcription in the design practice
- Champion the design system as engineering infrastructure — a DTCG-standard single-source-of-truth token API sync'ing Figma, iOS, Android, and Web
- Three-tier token hierarchy (global primitives → semantic → component), architecture supports server-driven UI
- Leading the mobile app redesign for engagement and retention across iOS, Android, web, and connected TV
- Partnering with engineering on the experimentation framework being built for rapid iteration and A/B validation
- Cross-functional partnership across a hybrid-distributed team (2 days Hamburg in-office, Berlin remote rest)

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk GmbH (European church-management SaaS, six-country localisation) · Copenhagen, Denmark · remote from Berlin

- Dual PM + design ownership on the Booking System (€20k, 2-month), reframing scope from "funeral-booking feature" into deep platform integration
- Design owned the build-vs-buy and standalone-vs-integrated decisions
- 70% reduction in coordination time, 90% booking acceptance rate, 20+ cemeteries in the Hanau region
- Multi-stakeholder coordination across funeral homes, pastors, cemeteries, and grieving families
- Adopted beyond the initial Hessen region as a core platform feature
- Applied Locus of Control Theory, Cognitive Load Reduction, and Progressive Disclosure as design constraints for grieving families
- Delivered a suite of modules to help client churches automate remote processes — shared inbox with ticket routing, booking requests, and case-management ticket system
- Shipped AI alt-text generation for EU accessibility compliance — 95% WCAG 2.1 coverage in production
- Established automated accessibility design processes
- Managed 1 direct report and served as main customer-facing contact for the launch parish with recurring validation calls
- Shipped across DE, DK, UK, SE, NO, and CH under Protestant and Catholic church-specific data-protection laws (GDPR-plus)

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (AI-powered no-code business platform, DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Managed 5 direct reports including a design lead and a writer
- Senior Leadership Team member with parity to product and engineering at SLT level
- Coached the design lead through a difficult engineering-lead partnership by reframing "what's wrong with that person" as "what's wrong with our system"
- Personally redesigned the team's collaboration system (pre-meeting prep, written agendas, structured turn-taking, written decisions)
- Included a sidelined engineer, who became one of the strongest contributors
- Structured habits spread beyond the accommodation and became team norm
- Made performance calls in both directions: hired 1 designer and 1 writer, let go 1 designer and 1 writer

- Actively shaped team composition and recruiting bar
- Designed the prompt-to-database AI onboarding model — founder-led stealth with CEO and technical co-founder
- Prompt-to-database with split-screen direct manipulation, schema renders into the real Ninox data-model editor

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead • *Spreadshirt* • 2014 – 2016 • Chat and direct manipulation – design and first-schema in a page handled as the normal case (–5,000 business sellers, hundreds of thousands of items) • Researched basis for the "AI beta (Feb 2026) automated journey" to controlled automation preserving a state-appropriate 9-month update and allowing users to edit" redesign after two prior attempts failed

- Championed shared governance of the design system across 4 designers and engineering

UX Manager • *HairDirect* • 2013 – 2014 • Lancashire • Built navigation model and first-solve search to drop down desktop-only B2C ecommerce operation via trend analysis and expert review of design trends data for engineering, design, and product to collaborate within

Broke the "nobody orders complex products on mobile" curse for custom hair-replacement products

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA — client-facing UX work at a design consultancy

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *Hypoport Hub SE (Hypoport Group shared service centre; service-to-product transformation)* Berlin / Lubeck, Germany · remote
microfinance non-profit, responsive design and cross-cultural accessibility

Web Designer · [Bajaa.com](#) · 2008 – 2009 · Remote
German agency

- Transformed individualised, case-by-case support into a standardised, scalable service catalog

Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Remote Worked on the IT Web design and ITSM & service desk implementation — internal operations tooling for the SME clients
rest of the Group

- Applied UX, Agile, and product methodologies to a service organisation
- Remote — early-career web design
- Designed and delivered design-thinking training programs for executive leadership and service teams

E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 - Hagen, Germany — first e-commerce role

- Primary stakeholder contact presenting to executives across internal client teams

SKILLS

Design Leadership & Coaching *Berlin, Germany & NYC, USA · cross-Atlantic*

- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for 5 years — 6-hour time-zone gap
- Established a time-boxed, strategic initiatives methodology for persona development, lighthouse design
- Projects, strategic progress (journey maps) to balance strategic and tactical work
- Hiring and performance calls in both directions
- Sustained design consistency through written decisions and async rituals
- CareerFoundry decade, IxDF, UX School Advisory Council and calls to NYC design with IBM and Fairbnb
- Redesigned the collaborative data analytics platform for data engineers, analysts, and business users at top US, Canadian, and UK banks and insurers
- Cross-functional prioritisation

AI-Era Product Design (product-side) environment

AI Copilot skill scoping (context loading, "good to build the design system from a script" prompt tuning, escalation logic) - User-agency design philosophy ("show Elevated design from an execution-focused functional and strategic business partner patterns (prompt-to-database with split-screen) - Secured executive support for user research initiatives in the regulated-industry context Production AI features (alt-text, CS Copilots) plus AI fundraising pipeline in build - Workshop leadership for AI adoption in design organisations ("Designing with and for AI" series)

AI-Native Design Practice (productivity-side)

Agentic prototyping as design method (web → Android via agentic coding; engineering consumes prototype code directly) · AI-generated prototyping evangelism · AI-assisted user research synthesis and transcription · Cursor · Claude Code · Zed · Documented design principles for AI integration into operational workflows

Design Systems & Cross-Platform Engineering

Design-system-as-API (DTCG standard format) · Three-tier token hierarchies (global / semantic / component) · Multi-platform sync (Figma / iOS / Android / Web / Connected TV) · Storybook · Figma Variables · Tokens Studio · Server-driven UI architecture · Shared-governance design system models across designer and engineering teams · React / Kotlin handoff workflows · SwiftUI · HTML / CSS / TypeScript

Research, Strategy & Distributed-Team Operations

Continuous research integrated into product cycles · Iterative user testing · Screening for hard-to-reach regulated personas · Research-as-strategic-input (Spreadshirt strategy change) · Multi-stakeholder validation calls · Cross-time-zone (Germany / NYC 6-hour-gap) collaboration playbook · Time-boxed strategic-initiatives methodology · Written-first decision artefacts · Async rituals · Workshop facilitation (Miro, Mural, FigJam) · UX psychology (Locus of Control, Cognitive Load Reduction, Progressive Disclosure) · Marketplace-UX pattern-recognition (two-sided platform conversion sensitivity, SKU / product-config density) · Metric ownership (70% / 90% / 95% / measured UX maturity)